

Git Clone Command

Introduction

The `git clone` command is used to create a **local copy of a remote Git repository** (usually from GitHub). It downloads all files, history, and branches from the remote repository to your system.

 **Watch the Video:**

https://youtu.be/jrar75KBHbE?si=dXQWQhCy-Vu4sF_9

What is Git Clone?

`git clone` helps you:

- Copy a repository from GitHub to your local machine
- Get full project history and files
- Start working on existing projects

Basic Syntax

```
git clone <repository-url>
```

Example:

```
git clone https://github.com/user/repo.git
```

Clone a Specific Branch

```
git clone -b <branch-name> <repo-url>
```

Example:

```
git clone -b dev https://github.com/user/repo.git
```

What Happens After Cloning?

- A new folder is created
- All project files are downloaded
- Git history is included
- Remote origin is automatically set

Check remote:

```
git remote -v
```

Difference: Git Clone vs Download ZIP

Git Clone	ZIP Download
Includes Git history	No history
Supports Git commands	Static files only
Can pull updates	Cannot update
Best for developers	Best for viewing only

When to Use Git Clone

- Starting work on a new project
- Contributing to open-source projects
- Downloading existing codebases
- Setting up development environments

Key Points

- `git clone` copies a full repository
- It connects local repo to remote origin
- Supports branches and history
- Essential for real-world development workflows